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Revised Instructions on Safe Deposit Locker Facility

In exercise of the powers conferred under the applicable statute, the following directions are issued. These directions shall come into force with immediate effect and shall supersede earlier instructions on the subject to the extent that they are inconsistent.

1. Model agreement

Banks shall execute a revised locker agreement with each existing locker holder in the form prescribed by the Indian Banks Association. The agreement shall be executed on stamp paper, the cost of which shall be borne by the bank.

2. Liability of the bank

Where loss of contents occurs on account of fire, theft, building collapse, or fraud committed by an employee of the bank, the liability of the bank shall be limited to one hundred times the prevailing annual rent of the locker.

3. Exclusion of liability

The bank shall not be liable for loss arising from an act of God, provided the bank has taken reasonable care of the premises. The onus of establishing such care shall rest with the bank.

4. Term deposit as security

A bank may obtain a term deposit at the time of allotment covering three years of rent and the charges of breaking open the locker. A term deposit shall not be insisted upon from an existing locker holder as a condition of continuing the facility.

5. Access notification

The bank shall send an email and a short message alert to the registered contact particulars of the locker holder at the close of the day on which the locker is accessed.

6. Dormant lockers

Where a locker has not been operated for a period exceeding three years, the bank may break open the locker after issuing notice to the holder, irrespective of whether the rent has been paid regularly.

7. Waiting list

Banks shall maintain a branch wise waiting list for locker allotment and shall issue an acknowledgement with a waiting number to every applicant.